

30 Days With Apple G5

Sanket Naik

It's difficult to describe the feeling. Elated? Umm, no. Happy? No, that's an understatement. However, one thing is for sure, the G5 makes the rest of the computing machines look like ironies.

Its OS really grows on you. Windows XP held no fascination anymore. Mac's smooth transitions, pristine graphics—beat that XP! My world of Windows and dialog boxes spun for the better. Here's how:

sanket_naik@thinkdigit.com

Day 1

The sleek 20-inch cinema display arrived today—the apple of our eyes. The chassis was big and bulky.

Day 3

In no time, I discovered that the system can be switched on from the monitor too!

Day 5

I know Windows XP like the back of my hand. But something with Unix lurking beneath? Hmm.. I wish my thoughts away and face the system. Am glad, very glad. The OS was as simple as simple can be. No hassles. An intuitive interface led me around swiftly. Changed desktops, wallpapers, themes and tinkered a little as

well—all in half a day!

Day 8

A feature called Expose (!) gets all open windows to show themselves at the push of a button. Then there is the genie effect that gets

applications to appear and 'shrink' away into the taskbar.

Day 10

The colour accuracy impresses. Crystal clear images with the right shade of blue or the right tinge in green make other LCDs look like hand-me-downs! The Mac is the brightest, and I'm convinced it's the best.

Day 15

Time to flaunt. I called in the design and the layout guys. Well, they were dumbstruck to see something that's pristine in its visual representation. I deftly got the G5 to show those minute differences in colour.

Day 18

Suddenly, the monitor screen blanked out. My heart skipped a beat.. Oh well, it turned out to be a power failure. But the damage had been done. Something was wrong with the operating system—it just wouldn't boot.

Day 20

I made several attempts to revive the system, to no avail. I called up Apple's engineers. A solution was offered politely. Another hour in getting that solution implemented, and the machine was up and running again.

Day 25

We got hold of Microsoft's Office 2004. It's better than the 2003 version I use with Windows. Applications such as iCal, iDVD, iTunes are all bundled with the system—marvellous!

Day 28

Time's up. I was in no mood to hand over the system to Apple. It needed our product coordinator a lot of nagging to persuade me to put the G5 into the box.

